

Charge of Discrimination — Leora Benton

Charge reference: SYN-EEOC-RIC-2025-0203. Charging party Leora Benton identified Blue Cedar Compliance, Inc. as her employer and checked sex discrimination and retaliation. She stated that she remained employed as a senior compliance audit manager when she signed the charge on February 3, 2025.

Benton reported that high-visibility audit leads supplied promotion credit and a weighted input to annual reviews. She said women were assigned planning and remediation work while male managers more often received the recorded lead designation. Her charge incorporated the written opposition she sent to Naomi Voss and Mira Solis on January 17.

The charge asked the agency to preserve assignment, scoring, and staffing data. It did not allege that a reduction in force had already begun.

Assignment examples stated in the charge

Benton identified three engagements. On Project Lantern, she drafted the control map and led the remediation conference, but Calvin Keene was listed as engagement lead. On Project Hearth, Benton replaced an unavailable manager for the field phase while Omar Ibarra retained the lead credit. On Project Juniper, Tessa Wynn received the lead designation after Benton prepared the risk plan and client presentation.

Benton wrote that the pattern affected visibility, client-continuity scores, and promotion readiness. She asked Blue Cedar to suspend use of the lead-credit total until it audited how the designation had been assigned.

The charge distinguished unequal assignment from ordinary workload disagreement: Benton said the distribution tracked sex and that the scoring consequence could reinforce the disparity.

Protected opposition and anticipated retaliation

Benton stated that her January 17 message used the words “sex-based assignment pattern” and requested a neutral review. Voss acknowledged the message the same day; Solis opened employee- relations matter ER-25-014 on January 21. Benton followed up on January 24 with assignment data and met with Solis on January 29.

According to the charge, Voss told Benton that leadership was considering “portfolio alignment.” Benton did not claim that statement itself was adverse. She asked the agency to note her concern that assignment scores could be used against her after she opposed the practice.

The charge requested protection against changes to duties, scores, compensation, or employment because of either her internal complaint or agency participation.

March 28 amendment concerning termination

Benton amended charge SYN-EEOC-RIC-2025-0203 on March 28, 2025. She stated that Blue Cedar received the original agency notice on February 10 and terminated her in a reduction in force on March 24. She identified Draven Pike as the executive who approved the selection.

The amendment alleged that Blue Cedar began a staffing process after receiving the charge. Benton stated that she had favorable performance, had completed regular travel, and still managed client transitions scheduled into June. She did not claim access on March 28 to Blue Cedar's internal workbook, calibration entries, or comparator exceptions. Her termination letter cited budget and redundant management work, not discipline or deficient performance.

Benton did not deny that Blue Cedar invoked a company cost-saving objective. She challenged how Blue Cedar selected her within the group it chose to compare.

Verification and administrative chronology

Benton declared that the charge and amendment were true to the best of her knowledge and belief. She signed the amendment on March 28 and incorporated the February 3 charge except where the termination allegations added later events.

Administrative chronology recorded with the charge:

- January 17: written internal opposition;
- February 3: original charge signed and transmitted;
- February 10: employer notice received by Blue Cedar;
- March 24: Benton's employment ends;
- March 28: amendment signed and submitted.

The amendment reports Benton's knowledge as of March 28. It does not include Blue Cedar's internal routing, workbook, calibration, or comparator records, which had not been produced to her.